

INTERNATIONAL

UFO

REPORTER

MARCH 1982

Vol. 7, No. 2

ISSN. # 0730-174X

The PRING 1981
Nocturnal Lights
Photograph

CONTENTS

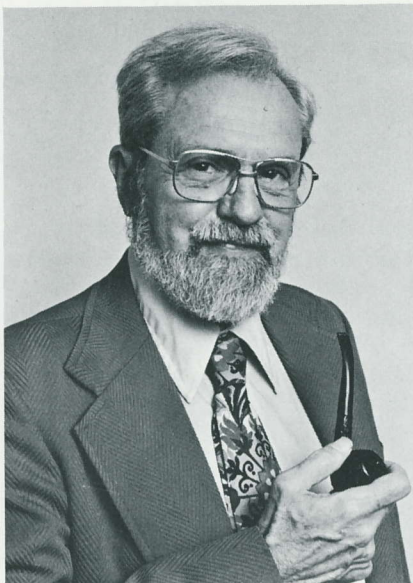
A Nocturnal Light Close
Encounter

A Professional Observation
UFOs on the Ski Slopes of
Northern Michigan

Chinese Editorial Board Photo
Hunting Old and New UFOs in
New Mexico

Profile: Robert Gribble

An
ASSOCIATE Publication
of the
CENTER FOR UFO STUDIES



Lauren Shay

Editor-in-Chief

J. Allen Hynek

Contributing Editors

Robert Gribble

Mark Rodeghier

Dr. Kenneth Schellhase

Production Manager

John P. Timmerman

Illustrations

Jennifer Scrivner

INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER (ISSN.# 0730-174X) is published bi-monthly by the CENTER FOR UFO STUDIES, P.O. Box 1402, Evanston, Illinois 60204. All rights reserved. Reproduction without permission is strictly prohibited. Copyright 1982 by Center for UFO Studies. Third Class postage paid at Lima, Ohio.

Address all editorial correspondence to INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER, P.O. Box 1402, Evanston, Illinois 60204, USA.

Address all subscription correspondence to INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER, P.O. Box 1621, Lima, Ohio 45802. (419) 223-2531.

The INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER is a benefit publication mailed to ASSOCIATES of the Center for UFO Studies contributing \$15.00 or more to the Center for UFO Studies. Foreign ASSOCIATES add \$5.00 for surface or \$10.00 for airmail delivery. All amounts in U.S. funds. Other publications also available to contributors of larger amounts. For details, write to P.O. Box 1621, Lima, Ohio 45802. USA. POSTMASTER: Send Form 3579 to CUFOS, P.O. Box 1621, Lima, Ohio 45802.

EDITORIAL

There are two observations about the gathering of data in Ufology that have been amply confirmed by serious workers in the field; they might almost be called "laws" of Ufology. The first is that the greater the Strangeness Index of a UFO sighting, the greater the delay in hearing about it. The second is that some of the best and most puzzling cases, again cases of high Strangeness, come to the attention of investigators by mere chance or serendipity — the unexpected finding of something while looking purposefully for something else. In this issue of the Reporter we have examples of both "laws."

The primary cause of the first is, of course, the reluctance to report a truly strange sighting because of the almost certain ridicule, disbelief, and harassment to which the hapless witness will be subject. Coupled with this is the natural reticence on the part of many to be considered mere story-tellers, or to tell of something which was highly personal and even traumatic. Sometimes the witness confides in a close friend and is then advised to say no more. Such accounts have very limited local circulation and we may hear of them much later by dint of accident or through strange circumstances. Thus the two "laws" are causally related.

In the case of the China Lake incident described in this issue, we learned of it only through the kindness of a relative of a man who, in the course of his duties at a military station, happened to come across it and sent it to him as a matter of curiosity. He, in turn, brought it to the attention of the Center. Thus was an old case finally brought to light.

The Reserve, N.M. case, of December 8, 1981, came to light entirely through serendipity. In this town of some 500 or so population there are two taverns, nearly across the road from each other. A practical joker painted a wavy line across the road connecting the two taverns and painted a sign "Caution: Drunks Crossing!" A reporter from the El Paso Times journeyed to Reserve to do a feature story on this prank and while there overheard some casual talk about the UFO incident. He did that story instead! It appeared in the Jan. 18, 1982 issue of the El Paso paper and only because I happened to be passing through that area at the time did I learn of it.

To continue the train of circumstances that finally brought the case to the attention of the nation, it so happened that a team from the ABC World News Report had asked the Center for a case they might use in connection with an update on the UFO situation. The Reserve N.M. case immediately came to mind as one they could investigate on location. They did so and thus, starting with a wavy line across a State road to network TV, this UFO saga had a wavy line of its own!

With respect to the inclusion of older cases in a publication primarily dedicated to the discussion of current UFO cases, we make no apologies. In a real sense an old case that has just surfaced is current; virtually no one has heard of it before and it might well constitute excellent research material.

J. Allen Hynek

How We Learn Of UFO Sightings

UFO sighting reports reach us from news departments, civilian organizations and individuals all over the world, but most of our reports are received via the Center for UFO Studies' UFO Hotline. This 24-hour, toll-free telephone service is for the exclusive use of U.S. law enforcement agencies, FAA facilities, planetaria and other formal channels. It permits the rapid follow-up of important cases for first-hand information from the reporting witnesses. It also permits: pre-screening of most hoaxes, rapid deployment of on-site investigators and the encouragement of local official assistance.

How We Define UFOS:

A UFO is any anomalous aerial phenomena whose appearances and/or behaviours cannot be ascribed to conventional natural or man-made causes either by the original witnesses or by other technically trained analysts after thorough investigation using the best techniques and equipment currently available.

- NL — Nocturnal Light: a distant anomalous light seen in the night sky.
- DD — Daylight Disc: a distant object seen under daylight conditions, often disc-shaped.
- RV — Radar/Visual: UFOs detected visually and by Radar simultaneously. Good agreement between the two accounts is essential.
- CE I — Close Encounter of the First Kind: a UFO seen within 500 feet.
- CE II — Close Encounter of the Second Kind: a CE I which includes a verifiable change in the environment such as physical traces, physiological effects and electromagnetic interferences.
- CE III — Close Encounter of the Third Kind: a CE I or II including the report of associated creatures, humanoids or robots.

LETTERS

The following letter was in response to our request to Paul Dong, of Oakland, CA and one of the editors of the Chinese "Journal of UFO Research", for a brief account of what is going on in China with respect to the UFO problem. For years nothing was learned about UFOs in China and the question was often asked whether there were indeed UFOs seen in China. We had heard from Jacques Vallee that a foreign correspondent was asked by one Chinese, "Do you see strange things in the sky in your country too?", which was a tip that China did have its share of UFO sightings. In Chairman Mao's day, however, UFOs apparently were not a permitted topic, but since then the attitude toward UFOs seems to have undergone a major change. But let Mr. Dong tell it:

Dear Dr. Hynek:

When I visited China last summer I was swarmed with crowds of "UFO fans" throwing questions at me everywhere I went. Some asked when Dr. Hynek would visit China. Was he pro-UFO or anit-UFO? Did he speak on behalf of the Government or express his own opinion? Had he ever seen a UFO? etc.

After China published the "Journal of UFO Research" in March 1981, it very soon sold 300,000 copies. Judging from the fact that subscribers are now from more than twenty different countries, it can be said that China's UFO research has caught the attention not only of the United States but of other countries as well.

China's UFO Research Organization was established in May, 1980, but long before 1977 there had been an informal UFO organization among the Chinese. Most of the members were students whose UFO research won support from newspaper and magazine editors who, as we know, were the ones who always got first hand information. Without the Government's acquiescence, however, their work would not have survived.

The UFO had become an issue for some time in China but until the UFO Research Organization was established, however, the Government's attitude toward the subject was not made clear. However it did not mean that work on UFOs had secured highest level support from the Government. I would like to give an illustration here: The UFO research done by the Soviet Academy of Sciences [actually, this work was only approved by the Academy] was denied by Pravda, but both of these are official bodies. We can also look at the United States: the research conducted by the Air Force was also disregarded and criticized by higher authorities. Here (in China) the problem is not that of being official or unofficial. The key is always the mystery of the UFO itself. Since no UFO has landed on the White House Lawn, or the Red Square, or Tien An Men Square, it provides an excuse for the anit-UFO group. They are opposed to these research efforts because according to them there is no observable evidence.

Since in every government there are supporters and opponents, it is easy for the opponents to say, "The United States has done research on UFOs for over twenty years without any concrete results. Why should we agonize ourselves by following in the footsteps of those who have failed?" Sayings such as these always catch some audience; in other words, UFO research is drawing both strong support and opposition everywhere. It is a very controversial issue.

Since it is a controversial issue, UFO research in China is slow. Also because we are just beginning, we know too little yet to tell the American readers. At the present stage, I am glad to say, many eminent scientists in China regard the subject of UFOs as very important and they wish to work very hard on it. Everywhere numerous eye witnesses to UFOs cry out loud to support the research.

Paul Dong

LETTERS

Dear Dr. Hynek:

I attended and enjoyed your recent seminar in L.A. We talked on a break and I told you I would write you about a theory of mine.

I doubt that UFO pilots are visitors from outer space because of a pattern I see in the history of UFO observations.

(1) In the 1890's, as we were moving from balloon travel towards heavier-than-air-craft, UFO's were seen and assumed to be a revolutionary new "airship" created by some unknown inventor.

(2) During World War II, the foo fighters were thought by all the combatants to be secret weapons of the other side.

(3) Kenneth Arnold saw his "flying saucers" as the world was entering the age of space travel. Ever since, both skeptics and true believers have argued the case for and against UFOs in terms of space travelers visiting the earth.

The pattern I see here is that in each of these three eras, UFO's were explained in terms of the frontiers of technology of the day.

The unknown could not remain a simple mystery until the facts were in. The unknown was quickly, automatically demystified by reference to the known, albeit the little known. We jumped to conclusions, conclusions that comforted and flattered us: (1) a man invented the "airship" (2) Men invented the foo fighters (3) other space travelers, like we were going to be, invented the flying saucers. Every time, the UFOs were coming from where we were "coming from."

It is as though a man were standing in a lighted room, peering out at the mysterious night. He seeks to learn what is out there, but all he can see is his own reflection.

Accepting that the extraterrestrial origin theory came into prominence as an unthinking condition-

ed response does not disprove it. (Perhaps the third time is a charm. Perhaps **this** time we jumped to the right conclusion.)

Personally, however, I think the space traveler theory should come down from the winner's stand and join the other contending hypotheses on the field in a continuing struggle to get at the truth.

Every hypothesis should have equal respect until the final outcome. I speak of time travelers, other dimensional beings, offspring of a parallel earthly evolution, beings with homes under the sea or in the earth, or my favorite contestant, the one with the shopping bag over his head labelled "the unknown (as yet unframed) hypothesis."

Thanks for the work you are doing.

Zan Overall

To all concerned,

Three Cheers for the new INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER format, style, etc. It is a big improvement and is now a publication of the FIRST KIND. I hope you will try to provide as much technical information as is feasible in order that we ASSOCIATES may utilize the publication when we get into those inevitable discussions with others about the UFO question.

E.T. Kendrick

Dear CUFOS,

I am very pleased to see that you are back to publishing IUR as a separate publication. I wish you success in its continued operation. It must be very frustrating at times not to have any real significant breakthroughs in explaining the UFO Phenomenon, but I think your scientific and objective investigations are an absolute necessity as long as sightings persist. Keep up the good work. One day your efforts will be vindicated.

Anita M. Berney

Editor,

With great pleasure I am renewing my membership as an ASSOCIATE of the Second Kind for this year and am glad that IUR is independent again. January Vol 7, No. 1 is great, with material concerning UFO research only, without any distractions.

Dimitri Ossipov

Editor,

New format is great, so easy to read, and articles are NOT continued in the back, a real improvement.

P. G. Rothstein

Good Morning,

Received the new INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER today's mail — Read cover-to-cover by 8 PM — Fine format — Good reading — Provocative articles — Deserves plaudits — STOP.

R. G. Shunk

Friends,

Congratulations (upon your) severance from FRONTIERS OF SCIENCE. I think it simplifies CUFOS problems and enhances CUFOS standing to stand alone with one defined set of problems.

William A. Rice

Hello,

I just received my first copy of the IUR under new cover and it looks terrific! I've been a loyal ASSOCIATE for many years and am really pleased to see the publication in this kind of professional and attractive style.

Caren Smith

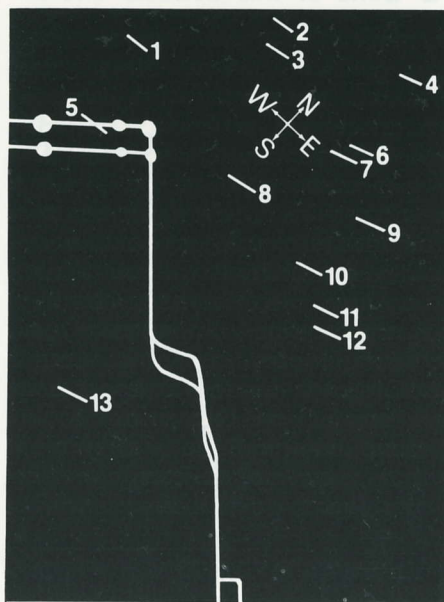
**Please write letters to:
Dr. J. Allen Hynek
Editor, I.U.R.
P.O. Box 1402
Evanston, IL 60204**

A Nocturnal Light Close Encounter

Our cover story this issue presents us with an outstanding puzzle. The original negative from which the cover picture was made is, at the time of writing, being studied by a west-coast laboratory . . . regarded by many as the best . . . and so this account must be considered as preliminary. The story, however, is so engrossing that our readers should have a chance to puzzle over it right away. Perhaps someone can come up with a plausible explanation, but so far no one has. Comments from readers will be welcomed.

It is our opinion that a hoax can be excluded; all the evidence and study so far argues solidly against that. Likewise, an inadvertent double exposure seems conclusively ruled out. Further, the lights were seen while the time exposure was in progress and, short of accusing both witnesses of egregious falsification, totally out of keeping with their known characters, the photo must be regarded as genuine. But what is it a photo of?

Here is the story of how the picture came to be taken; Rupert Pring and his wife had heard over the radio that a meteor shower would be visible that night, Aug. 12, 1981, after midnight. This is the well-known Perseid meteor shower which is visible each year around that date. And so Pring, a retired master electrician and a camera hobbyist as well, went out some distance from their town (Anderson, IN.) to get away from town lights and set up his tripod and camera. (See cover photo.) The camera, a Minolta with a 28 mm lens, was placed near the driver's side of the car and shortly after midnight began a series of 15 minute exposures, retiring to the car in between times. No cars bothered him on that lonely country road at that time of night.



STAR IDENTIFICATION

1. Chi Persei
2. Beta Persei (Algol)
3. Rho Persei
4. Gamma Andromedae
5. Eta Tauri
6. Beta Trianguli
7. Gamma Trianguli
8. Delta Arietis
9. Alpha Trianguli
10. Alpha Arietis (Hamal)
11. Beta Arietis
12. Gamma Arietis
13. Delta Ceti

Apparently two independent trails started far to the south, continued northeast, stopped, and then took off, roughly to the southeast, through the constellation Taurus. The last part of this journey according to Mr. Pring, took just six seconds. It is important to note that the fainter trail came in as a straight line and was joined by the second, brighter, trail that also came in from the south, made a sharp right angle, and then accompanied the faint trail on its northeastern journey. They then both stopped briefly before making the right angle turn to the southeast. From then on both lights acted in complete concert, stopping briefly near the star Eta Tauri and then once again to the southeast of that star.

Careful examination of the photograph shows that both lights were "strobe-type", with the flashes growing farther apart toward the end, indicating that the lights accelerated, as indeed Mr. Pring said they did. One can estimate that the lights were in the field of the camera for less than a minute. The "strobe" nature of the lights tend to rule out an inadvertent double exposure caused by the shutter being accidentally open when being taken off the tripod and turned toward some passing car.

Without the star trails the photograph would be of little value. They furnish the frame of reference so often lacking in UFO photographs. Note the gentle curve of the star trails. The center of curvature is, of course, the North Pole of the sky, around which all stars in the northern hemisphere of the sky circle once a day. From the length of the trails we gather at once that the exposure was eight minutes long and not fifteen as originally stated. There is no arguing with an astronomical photograph!

So much for what the photograph tells us independently of the witness's testimony. We shall probably know more when the analysis of the negative itself has been completed. Coming now to what Mr. Pring himself had to say about the event: He said that when he got out of the car he "froze in position" and felt a very heavy pressure from above. He likened it to the feeling he has experienced in the past when working around heavy electrical equipment and power lines. "It was one of the most uncomfortable feelings I've ever had. I felt like something heavy was pushing down on my head and shoulders." He experienced nausea for some three days afterward and indicated that he also had a temporary loss of memory for about a day.

A Nocturnal Light Close Encounter

He took eight exposures in all. Even with his ASA 400 film it would take a bright, slow moving meteor to register, and so it is not surprising that he did not photograph any meteors. The Perseids are known for their faintness and angular speed, appearing as streaks of light zipping across the sky. The first seven photos recorded only star trails, but then it happened. Pring had started his eighth exposure and returned to the car three to five minutes later, as he relaxed in the driver's seat he became aware of a very bright light in the sky. Jumping out of the car he looked up to see two bright lights momentarily hovering fairly high in the sky; then they quickly moved to the southeast, stopping and brightening twice for an instant, according to Pring, and disappeared rapidly. Pring's observation lasted for only six seconds (as determined later by re-enacting the event and using a watch), but the camera apparently saw much more.

From an astronomer's viewpoint, what makes this photograph of particular interest (apart from the UFO!) is precisely that it is an astronomical photograph. From the length of the star trails one can tell exactly how long the exposure was and if one knows exactly where the camera was pointed, one can calculate the exact time the photo was taken. Conversely, if the time of the photo is known, the exact point in the sky to which the camera was pointing can be deduced. There is no arguing with an astronomical photograph, but human memory is always subject to error. In this case, Mr. Pring states that it was 2:15 A.M. and that the camera was pointed vertically. Assuming the time to be correct, the camera could not have been vertical, but pointing toward the east. If the camera was pointing vertically and the time was also correct, then the date was not Aug. 12 but the middle of September.

None of this detracts one bit from the value of the photograph. The stars have all been identified (Page 5); the camera was pointing skyward and photographing the stars and during the course of the exposure a very strange pair of lights appeared and moved in a most interesting way. Mr. Pring's observation did not start apparently until the lights had reached the point at which they made a right angle turn. Either they paused at the right angle and then went on to pause twice more (thus accounting for the three pairs of bright spots) or they suddenly and very briefly (there is little elongation of the bright spots) brightened as they moved along. Pring states that they both paused and brightened, which would account for things nicely.

Naturally, in good UFO investigations we look first for possible prosaic explanations for any intriguing reported UFO event. Undoubtedly our readers will suggest some and, of course, helicopter will certainly be on the list. This, however, appears to be ruled out not only because of the complete absence of sound (the night was extremely quiet and a person standing outside a car parked on a completely deserted country road at 2:15 A.M. would surely have heard any craft close enough to exhibit such bright lights) but because of the trail patterns. Study shows that these could be explained as coming from a low flying plane having two fixed lights but flying in such a manner that the plane pivoted around one light (which maintained straight flight) in such a way as to have the two lights lined up in the direction of motion, then banking or tilting to produce the individual trails shown entwined, then stopping momentarily, and then proceeding at right angles to the original motion with, however, no further change in the alignment of the lights. This can only be considered as a highly contrived and virtually impossible maneuver.

The smaller separation of the trails at the beginning (1½ degrees) and two degrees at the end, plus the increase of brightness of the trails as they progress, argues that the lights were coming closer before they sped away. If the time as given by Mr. Pring is correct, then the lights could at no time have been directly over the car but to the north of east and at a considerable angle to the vertical. Nonetheless, the brightness of the trails, much brighter than those of the second magnitude stars Alpha Arietis and Gamma Andromedae, plus the fact that it took eight minutes for the stars to imprint their trails and a matter of seconds for the lights to do so argues for very intense lights. Mr. Pring described them as "bright as a halogen automobile headlight at 50 feet."

If those were the lights of a plane so far away that it could not be heard, we are asking for extremely bright lights! Assuming the lights to have been fixed to one structure, as their synchronous action would argue, then the following table gives us the separation of the lights at various assumed distances as well as the speed of the plane in miles per hour:

Distance	Separation	Mi. Per Hr.
200 feet	7 feet	6
500	17.5	15
1000	35	30
2000	70	60
5000	175	150
2 miles	370	320

If the plane were at a "no hearing" distance, then not only do we call for a very large plane (which therefore should have been all the more audible) but the speed becomes excessive for a helicopter, the only craft that could even conceivably maneuver in the recorded manner. The speeds in the last column were computed on the assumption that the lights traversed the parallel portion of their paths in six seconds, as Mr. Pring estimated using a stopwatch.

A PROFESSIONAL OBSERVATION

If the bright spots were caused by the lights stopping momentarily, then a helicopter could not have "stopped on a dime" in that manner. If the lights kept moving uniformly but brightening to produce the spots, then the spots should appear elongated. They are nearly round. Apart from the question of what a completely silent helicopter might be doing at 2:15 a.m. over a very rural spot in Indiana, the helicopter solution does not appear to be viable. What then? An ordinary plane is completely out; it could not maneuver in that manner. Ball lightning? If so, then this is really one for the books!

A meteor is likewise completely out; meteors do not turn at right angles. We are left with the bottom of the bag of tricks for possible explanation: hoax or double exposure. Mr. Pring sent the roll of film to Indianapolis for development and it was returned in a week or so. One skeptic has gone so far as to suggest that Mr. Pring superposed an oscilloscope trace over the star trails! Another, that he inadvertently kept the shutter of the camera open as he carried the camera and photographed the headlights of an oncoming car. Not only were there no cars at that time of night, but cars in general do not have stroboscopic headlights!

Do you have a possible natural explanation? If so, let us hear from you. Send your comments to the editorial offices of the Reporter in Evanston. We'll include them in a future update on this intriguing case.

ICJR

For Your Information
Order The CUFOS
Catalog of Publications

Describing 100 Items
Now Available. Send \$1.00 to
CUFOS, P.O. Box 1402
Evanston, IL 60204 (USA)

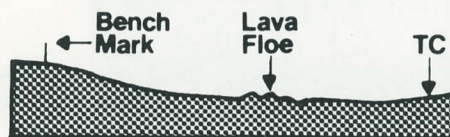
TYPE: CE I-II
DATE: Jan. 18, 1966
TIME: 4:55 P.M. PST
DURATION: 1 min (20 min.)
WITNESSES: Two
PLACE: China Lake, CA.

A civilian recently employed at the China Lake Naval Ordnance Test Station, in California, unearthed (method not related) a UFO report made (and buried in the files) some sixteen years ago. The report itself is unclassified. Probably it went from desk directly to files and nothing more was done about it.

Since it originated at a Weapons Test Station, one immediately wonders whether a secret weapon was being described, for it often happens at such installations that the proverbial right hand doesn't know what the left hand is doing. But did we have anything like this in 1966?

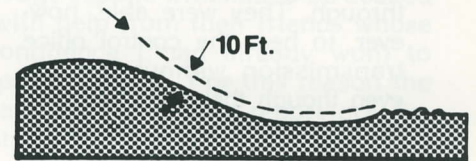
The report came to the attention of CUFOS in a circuitous manner; it follows here almost in its entirety because of its professional nature:

"On Tuesday, 18 Jan. 1966, at 4:55 P.M. PST, on Baker Range at the Naval Ordnance Station, two Civil Service-employed surveyors were involved in sighting a UFO. One man was standing at a bench-mark monument, about 117 deg. W., 35 deg 52 min N. at 3004 ft. above sea level, using a Wild T-3 Theodolite in a survey of points in the area. Two of their targets were in line with the BIC flight line, one being a blinking flash lamp about 5 miles distant, located on the far side of an ancient lava flow.



"One man was taking readings with the theodolite; the other was sitting in the truck recording the readings. The first man heard a noise described as a 'kind of hum' but also like a jet plane cruising at high altitude. Looking

up he saw a UFO flying nearly straight at him from an angle of between 35 and 40 degrees and from almost exactly north. The UFO passed directly overhead (being surveyors they probably meant 'overhead,' a term very loosely used by the layman) at a height of much less than 150 feet. Diving smoothly it appeared to turn slightly to the east and came to within about 10 feet of the sloping ground, down the flight line, but perhaps 10 feet to the east of the center of the flight line (see sketch).



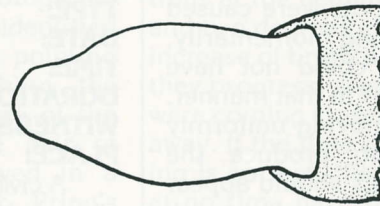
"After it passed overhead the first observer loosened the elevation lock on the theodolite and aimed the 40x sighting telescope on the UFO, observing it as it flew down the flight line until its detail became lost in front of the lava floe, about two miles away.

"Both observers agree that the speed was about 150 mph as it passed overhead and that it was a dull black color. There were no noticeable control surfaces and no lights visible (see sketches). The first man described the UFO as a thing of great beauty in shape and movement. It was very quiet (remarkable for an aircraft just 150 feet away). No heat was felt. Both men agreed on the size of the object (12x8x1) and that the bottom was flat.

"The first observer was somewhat reluctant to report seeing a 'wake' behind the UFO. It was as if the rear section was disturbing the surrounding air...something like a plane 'dumping fuel.' It was more like a Schlieren pattern observed in a wind tunnel. His hesitancy resulted from the belief that it was impossible to see turbulence or shock wave with the unaided eye.

A PROFESSIONAL OBSERVATION

"It was more like a Schlieren Pattern observed in a wind tunnel."



"The men immediately attempted to radio a report into the range control office. The radio-man in the office heard their call as very garbled, as if it were being jammed. A few words did get through. They were able, however, to hear the control office transmission without trouble, even though their own transmission continued to be garbled for some time. After having no success at radio reporting, they attempted to start the truck, but with no success. The starter motor would barely turn the engine over and the engine would not catch.

"They decided to finish their theodolite readings and did so in about five minutes, and then stored their gear. They pushed the truck down the hill to get it started. It ran poorly as they drove to the lava floe to make some observations there. From the time of the UFO overflight to this time was less than 20 minutes."

It is not known who wrote the report. It very well could have been the observers themselves who preferred to use the third person to make it less direct and personal. The report continues with a point that might possibly be relevant:

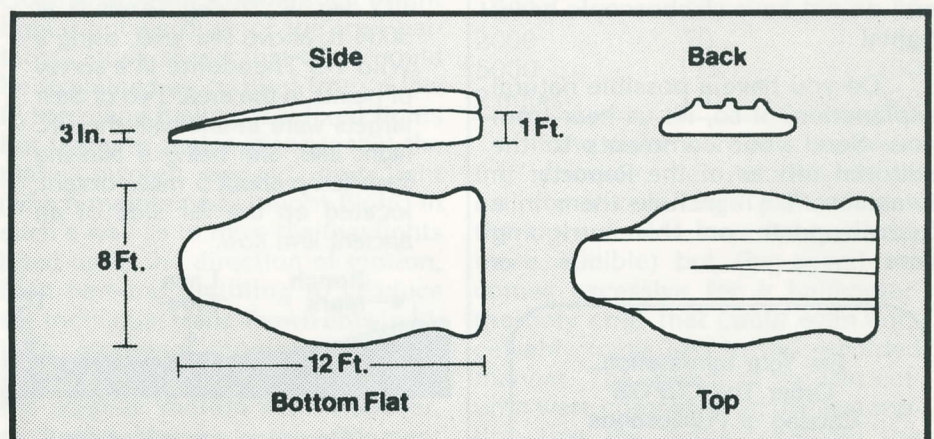
"After the overflight, it was necessary to re-level the theodolite. It had moved to the west by 5 level graduations. The operator insists that he did not put enough force on the theodolite to cause this mislevel; the plumb bob indicated the instrument was

still centered over the prick-punch reference on the bench mark. If he had kicked the tripod, the plumb bob would almost certainly have been misaligned. Further, with his experience in surveying operations and the lack of physical movement required to follow the UFO with telescope, it is very unlikely that he had exerted any appreciable force on the instrument. No plausible explanation has been offered for the change in the gravity reference indicator...the bubble is a spirit vial.

"It is probable that these estimates of size, height, and speed are as reliable as any reported to date because measurement of objects and distances is the daily work of these surveyors. Their integrity is excellent."

What, then, shall be the verdict? A deliberate hoax, placed in the files to gather dust for years? Or, more likely, a report made in good faith out of a sense of duty, submitted to higher authorities who then quietly filed it? I have talked at length with the civilian employee who discovered the existence of the report, who then sent it to an uncle in New York, who then in turn sent it on to the Center. I learned something of its history. The report was filed, the employee tells me he was able to find out, in good faith and with serious intent in the hope that the officials at the Base would submit it to higher authorities in the government. Apparently nothing was done. The Center will attempt to probe a little deeper into this case, but sixteen years have elapsed and the trail is cold. Any further developments will, of course, be reported in this publication.

IGR



OBJECT SIGHTED
CHINA LAKE, CALIFORNIA (January 18, 1966)

UFOs on the Ski Slopes of Northern Michigan

The Briar Mountain Case

Dr. Kenneth Schellhase

The following intriguing account might well be called "UFOs on Skis" although their method of going up and down ski slopes is hardly the traditional one. It resulted from the "Iron Mountain Experiment" (see IUR, Jan 1982, p. 4). At that time so many UFO sighting came to light, and there was so little time for immediate investigation, that I asked Dr. Schellhase to undertake a more detailed investigation for the Center. This he did, but the following report deals only with a few central incidents, while summarizing several related ones reported in that area. Dr. Schellhase is preparing further material for publication based on the activity in the Iron Mountain area. The present account of the Briar Mountain events, or the Vulcan Hill UFOs, is given here with minimum editing in order to allow Dr. Schellhase to tell the story in his own words and style.

Norway, Michigan, is a very small town eight miles east of the town of Iron Mountain, and like many towns the Michigan's Upper Peninsula, thrives mainly on tourism and skiing. Shouldering the town is Briar Mountain (also known as Vulcan Hill) whose northern face overlooks the vast stretches of the Sturgeon River and Ford River State Forests. It is crowned by an attractive Ski Lodge where once had been only a fire tower and an Air Force radar tower operated remotely from Antigo, Wis. The latter was abandoned by the Air Force a dozen years ago and until the fall of 1981 its ugly remains were used only to hang two one-thousand watt halogen lamps for the benefit of night skiers. Some people say that UFOs will no longer be attracted to the place like they used to be with the disc-shaped radar platform and the bright lights gone.

There is no basis to this speculation; the UFOs are still coming around. The Hill and the sur-

rounding area for better than a twenty mile radius has been reported as a hotbed of UFO activity for three decades and by last count, still continues to be. The area includes Norway, Niagara, Florence (see the CUFOS Bulletin, Summer 1981), Spread Eagle, Iron Mountain, Felch, Foster City and throughout Dickinson and Delta counties in Michigan, and northern Wisconsin. These reports were not easy to come by, but it is remarkable the way in which the investigation of one case in a given area leads to the discovery of others in that area.

Briar Mountain stands out for its flurry of sightings between October 1976 and March of the following year, which reached a peak in January and February. Almost all of the fifty employees at the Lodge were treated to as many as twenty to

thirty displays over two or three months. Numerous visitors were also fortunate to experience some of these events. The words 'treated', 'display', and 'fortunate' are perhaps ill-used. More accurately, an owner of a major American newspaper and eight business friends were reportedly 'shocked' by what they saw. (My letter to the publishing magnate has not yet been answered!) Also, several of the employees of the Lodge I spoke with had to be coaxed (with help from their friends whose confidence I had already won) to speak with me. For this reason the names used in this report are fictitious.

Eino Maki, chief slope groomer at the Lodge, was one who had been very disturbed and shaken by his sightings. (Ed. Note: During my brief visit to the Iron Mountain area, Maki was one of the few witnesses I



CUFOS

Chairlift of slope B, looking directly down. Note bald plateau in center of picture immediately below horizon. Maki described much UFO activity over it.

UFOs on the Ski Slopes of Northern Michigan

had the opportunity of personally interrogating; I found his story most unusual and captivating, and Maki himself straightforward and convincing.) It was my frequent wish while interviewing Maki to have some UFO-skeptics present to listen to this intelligent and warm man, graced with a good sense of humor, relate his experiences with steady speech but now and then revealing unsuccessful attempts to conceal sighs and voice quiverings occasioned by remembered fears.

Maki saw more UFOs, and saw them closer, than anyone else at the Lodge because he had the most opportunity to do so. He had to prepare the ski slopes for the next day's skiers and this had to be done for long hours almost every night, and into the wee hours of the morning. Eino's first observations of Nocturnal Lights came in December 1976. These were typical of those reported by the Indians of the Yakima Indian Reservation (see CUFOS Bulletin, Spring 1981): reddish orange lights, flaring up to brilliant white and comparable to Venus, half-moon, to full moon. When they flared up, large areas of the terrain directly under them were illuminated. Their motions were generally leisurely, sometimes taking as long as 30 minutes but at other times crossing the sky, horizon to horizon, in three to five seconds. Sometimes two smaller ones would emerge from a larger one, speeding off to the west and then returning from that direction, often to merge with another.

One very interesting item is that three witnesses reported that one NL would customarily get out of the way when the mail plane from Escanaba (forty-five miles to the east) would come by at about 11 P.M., returning to its position when the plane had passed. Three witnesses also reported that an official of the Lodge called the Sawyer Air Base (fifty-five miles to the northeast) and shortly thereafter two fighter planes appeared and made a series of criss-cross passes over the

area and then returned to Base. It was reported that on this occasion the UFO grew very dim and nestled closer down among the trees.

It is however, the Close Encounters with these ski-slope UFOs that are to the point here [Ed. Note: Dr. Schellhase will in due course publish a special report of a more technical nature on the Upper Peninsula UFOs]. There were five CE-I and at least one CE-II (EM effect) observed at the Lodge from November 1976 to May 1977 and several CI-I's in the nearby area. Maki was the prime observer for three of the CE-I's at the Lodge.

It was about 3 A.M. on a night in mid-January the first time; Maki was busy grooming the slopes. By now he had grown somewhat accustomed to the NL's: "Sometimes they play like a star and hide, and at other times they just move above the ground...I don't know how they do it." But he wasn't mistaking stars for NL's; in his long hours of work he had observed how the background of stars "would move all night on you" as stars do, but the NL's moved quite independently of the stars.

"Soon, it got too close for comfort and Maki went back up . . . and hid behind the Lodge."

What truly disconcerted Maki this morning, however, was that one of them had seemingly singled him out to keep pace with as he moved back and forth on the slope. Maki would go up the slope, it would mimic him; he would go down the slope, it would go down. It did this many times. Maki remarked, "So I say, well, something's kind of funny, But I wasn't too worried about it; he was quite a way off. I was watching him all the time." But then, still keeping pace with Maki, up and

down, the UFO kept on edging closer all the time — by now literally going up and down on the same angle as Maki on the slopes. At first the UFO mimicking him had been two miles away at most, moving always at tree-top level. But the closer it came the more Maki could see red lights on the object, "like blackout lights on an army vehicle; you could see them from close but not from far away." Soon it got too close for comfort and Maki went back up to the Lodge, turned off his machine, ran out of it, and hid behind the Lodge. The UFO had imitated Maki by going up (out of sight beyond the trees to the west of the Lodge) — but this time it didn't come back down! Maki waited ten or fifteen minutes before resuming his work. The whole operation of the Lodge depended upon Maki getting the slopes in skiable condition. "So I started grooming again. I went up and down a couple of time. I went up and I came back down and he was right below me on the run, on the same run [emphasis original]; and then he was big, bright, you know, that thing shining on me, bright; so I turned the machine and went to the top of the hill and I jumped in my pickup and went home, see? I ran home."

In Maki's second CE-1, about one week later, about 11:00 p.m., a UFO again began apeing Maki's up and down movement. As before, it edged closer and closer. Again Maki saw the little red lights on it. It got too close. "I had the feeling that that was the cat out there and I was the mouse, when they come close like that." This time Maki didn't wait for the finale. "And I took off. I ran home again. And I hid in the traffic, back and forth so they couldn't follow me. I know that's going to be pretty hard to believe, but that's what I did." The emphasis is Maki's and it underscores an interesting point: he was more incredulous about his own fear than about the UFO! Having spoken with Maki several times and having spoken with several of his business associates

and friends, all I see is that Maki is of extremely solid of character, tough yet very gentle, and well liked by everyone. He is also very intelligent and a careful observer. When this kind of man gets frightened, it's amazing both to himself and to others.

Unfortunately, for both these CE-1 cases there were no other known observers. For the third however, there is one for certain and perhaps up to a dozen or more others. In mid-February, about 10:30 p.m. (with still many people in the Lodge — which closed at midnight). As in the first two cases, the UFO imitated Maki's tractor movements. As in the first case, it went up out of sight above the trees on the summit to the west of the Lodge and did not come down again. But this time an even more terrifying thing happened. With Maki working his way up a slope the UFO suddenly appeared right over him. It illuminated him and a large area around him. He raced his tractor at top speed (about fifteen miles per hour) and purposefully drove under the struts, wires, and chairs of the chairlift "so the thing couldn't get at me; it would have to crash through a lot of stuff to get me." Jake Malone, the assistant manager, recalls fearing there had been a bad accident out on the slopes when he heard Maki's tractor coming up in fourth gear — that he was coming up to have someone call a doctor or the ambulance. When Malone looked outside, he watched for at least a full minute as a huge brilliantly white shining object "about the size of a boxcar" followed above Maki right up the slope. Towards the top Maki got ahead of it while the UFO, as observed by Malone, hovered about five hundred feet from the Lodge. As it hovered it bounced gently up and down. By now Maki had hidden behind the Lodge but was able to move out far enough from the side of the building to see the UFO hovering partly over the radar tower and partly over the

Lodge towards its north side. The UFO then moved a little south to overlap both the greater part of the Lodge directly over its roof and a high voltage pole a little to the southwest of the Lodge. Maki estimates that the UFO was sixty to eighty feet long. While he watched, five persons stepped out of the main entrance, on the south side, facing the parking lot. One or two of these ran back in to tell others—who had already been informed by Malone of what he saw. Maki then recalls some ten to fifteen people collecting just outside the main door. Maki heard no sound from the UFO and he asked the other people watching; and they heard nothing. Maki was impressed that something powerful enough to give off so much light could be so quiet, while being so

low, less than three hundred feet.

It is unfortunate that the other witnesses to this last startling case could not be located at this late date, or when located, refused to speak. It will require much more work to be able to present a coherent picture of and report on the Upper Peninsula UFOs in the face of the recalcitrance of the witnesses who, it is obvious, are certainly not publicity-seekers, a charge so often made by skeptics who have never left their arm chairs to work with actual real-life witnesses. Perhaps in time, as the climate of opinion on these matters changes for the better, it will become much easier to conduct professional investigations of UFO events.

IJR



Pictured here are staff members of the Chinese JOURNAL OF UFO RESEARCH editorial board, 1981. Photo courtesy of Paul Dong, who provided other photos of lectures on UFOs taken at Ching Hua University, Jinan University of Canton and the Peking Planetarium.

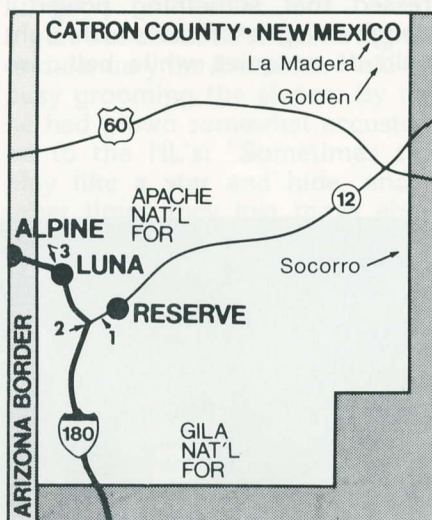
Hunting Old And New UFOs In New Mexico

In our editorial this issue the humorous manner in which a recent UFO event near the small town of Reserve, N.M. came to light is described. At about that same time a very old UFO event surfaced, one that occurred at about the same time as the famous Socorro, N.M. case in which the policeman Lonnie Zamora was the witness. This one happened in the now-ghost town of Golden, N.M., in 1964, about 100 miles or so to the north of Socorro. Both the recent Reserve case and the old Golden case came to the attention of the Center because I happened to be in New Mexico shortly after the Reserve event.

The Golden incident came to my attention through Lee Williams of TV station KOB in Albuquerque, again purely by chance. Perhaps the best way to present this case is just to relate how it unfolded when Lee Williams, James Scartacinni (the eye witness to the effects of this CE-ll case of 1964, who was then just 15 years old) and I visited the remembered site of the landing the day after Mr. Williams had told me of the existence of the witness and of the site. The remembered site is shown in the photograph on page 14.

Mr. James Scartacinni is a miner of substantial means although he lives very simply. He remembers that as a lad of fifteen he and his grandfather made their way to this site as a result of a story told by two Spanish-speaking natives who had walked some nine miles to town to tell a strange story. They told of a light that had come down from the sky the previous night and had left three "smelted" circles some two feet in diameter and separated from each other by some 20 feet. His memory, combined with his present knowledge of the smelting of ores, of which he does a great deal, led Mr. Scartacinni to surmise that the "burned" circles must have been subjected to a temperature of at least 2300 degrees.

There was no crashed saucer or any craft, or parts thereof, when James and his grandfather viewed the site; only the "smelted" areas were there. Convinced that something very strange had indeed happened there, they returned to town and placed a call to the State Police who, in turn notified the military. Almost immediately, men in uniform appeared, cordoned off the area, and carefully dug up the burned areas to a depth of more than a foot and carried the material away. From that point on, no questions were answered, nor was anything further said of the removal.



The significant part of the story from our standpoint is that James and his grandfather had seen the site *before* the military arrived; they had seen no craft or "misguided" missile. Whatever had produced the high temperatures had evidently departed under its own power. This rules out some secret device that had gone astray and had crashed there. Why, then, were the military so immediately interested?

James remembers only that it happened "about the same time as the Socorro sighting" which had received considerable press attention. There is no record of the Golden case in the Blue Book files*

but they do contain an account of a very similar one that occurred just two days after the Socorro event,** at La Madera, N.M. which is about as far north of Golden as Golden is north of Socorro. It presents easily as much of a mystery as does the Golden incident, and for that reason it should be included in this account of the hunting down of New Mexico UFOs. The Blue Book summary reads: "Witness reported seeing an object emitting flames. Police called to investigate. No noise. Object stationary. Light suddenly went out . . . area where light was emitted was used as a dumping area. Burned spot at this location." Based on this evidence alone, the Air Force officially logged this as "Fire in Dump". The Albuquerque Tribune for April 27, 1964, however, carries this story (excerpts only here): "A Santa Fe resident reported today he sighted an unidentified flying object early Sunday near La Madera, northwest of Espanola. State Police also received a report from two men traveling in the same general area late Saturday night that a flying object, definitely not an airplane, swooped down toward their car, then veered off. (This would have been some 2 hours before the La Madera sighting). "There was definitely something there", said State Police Capt. Martin Vigil after visiting the site at La Madera. The ground was still smoldering 20 hours after the sighting."

The Santa Fe resident (who was visiting his father in La Madera) was Orlando Gallegos, and the newspaper story continues, "Gallegos said he went outside to chase some horses. It was then he saw the thing sitting on the ground in a gravel area. Gallegos said he was about 200 feet away and was afraid to approach closer . . . Gallegos returned twice to look at the object. He described it as being of bright metal without windows, as long as a telephone pole and

about 14 feet in circumference. He said it was egg shaped and resembled a large butane tank. At daylight Sunday the object was gone, but the ground was still smoldering." Fire in Dump?

The similarity of this sighting to the Socorro event two days previously is striking, yet the Socorro case was officially listed as Unidentified while this one was dismissed. In 1964 when I was in Socorro investigating that case, some days after the event, I heard of the La Madera case but I was not authorized to investigate and had to return to Ohio.

It is an interesting coincidence that the names of the two lads who had first reported the Golden case were also named Gallegos. This, however, is a fairly common name in that area.

These three old New Mexico cases offer us an interesting insight into the disparate investigative methods employed by Blue Book. In the Socorro case an immense effort was made (probably because the case had gained prominence in the news), through highest channels, to see whether a secret device of some sort had been launched from some base in that area and which then, presumably, went astray. Nothing was ever turned up. In the La Madera case, however, which was very similar, the verdict "Fire in Dump" was lightly handed down. The Edgewood-Golden case was not even recorded.

The Reserve N.M. Case

TYPE:	NL plus Craft
DATE:	Dec. 8, 1981
TIME:	7:30 P.M.
DURATION:	Approx. 5 min.
WITNESSES:	8 (several independent)
PLACE:	Three and six miles south of Reserve, N.M., Luna, N.M. (12 miles west of Reserve)

Turning now to the recent New Mexico case: it combines several dramatic elements and, looked at in one way, offers support to those who feel that the whole UFO phenomenon is a matter of man-made deception and man-made devices. There are strong elements that deny this. The reader should enjoy this one!

The witnesses were located as shown on the accompanying map. Alma Hobbs and her two children were driving southwest on State Route 12, 3 miles below Reserve (Location 1); Dan Luscomb and two waitresses were just outside his restaurant, where State 12 meets US 180 (Location 2); Lancelot and Neil Swapp viewed the object from outside their home on US 180 in Luna, N.M. (Location 3) a small, almost entirely Mormon Community.

Mrs. Hobbs and her children saw it first. It was ahead of them and to their left as they drove along. It appeared suddenly as a pumpkin orange ball rising upward from the ground. As they continued to drive for 3 or 4 miles toward Location 2, they watched it for 4 or 5 minutes and saw it assume a horizontal position as it crossed in front of them, heading southwest. It then "came directly back on itself, back on its own path", and then turned north, passing relatively close to Mrs. Hobbs. "It would have been about 70 degrees angle from us, y'know, into the air" Mrs. Hobbs told us. Then it did a 90 degree turn near Luna mountain; "it was so fast I couldn't trace the movement with my eyes," she continued.

Mrs. Hobbs said that then she saw a jet chasing the object. The speed of the object was "real fast-looking at times", especially when the jet was near. "When the jet came up toward it, well, it just moved away from that jet real fast." (Compare this to the Luscomb account below).

As to size, "the thing was enormous, maybe 250 yards long. It was between us and the mountains . . . if we had only been closer to the mountains!" It had no wings and no flashing lights. The mountains which served as a backdrop for the object were about 11 miles away, and this sets an upper limit to its distance. Mrs. Hobbs estimates that it was 5-6 miles away when it first crossed their path but about 2 miles distant at its closest.

After it made its 90 degree turn west, it proceeded out of sight over the mountain pass. She then told her children, "Don't tell anyone; no one will believe us", but when they got to the restaurant (their sighting ended when they were a mile or less from the restaurant) Mrs. Hobbs found Dan Luscomb phoning the FAA in Albuquerque, inquiring whether they had the object on radar. "You saw it too?" she asked when she heard the conversation. Now she felt safe to talk about it.

Shortly before Mrs. Hobbs arrived, Dan Luscomb had been sitting in his restaurant at the Whispering Pines Resort (one block south of the intersection of US 180 and State 12). Suddenly, Rosie Tafoya came rushing in from her home (a short distance from the restaurant) crying, "Dan, you must see this!" Dan first viewed it looking due south. He said it was some 2000 feet over the mountain ridge and "made a loop around, right over 180, and then Venus was in its way." It went right in front of Venus, Dan reported, (Venus was near greatest brilliancy then, and a spectacular object in the southwest; this is the first time Venus has been occulted by a UFO!) and "we got a beautiful view of it", referring, I expect, to both Venus and the object.

Then they saw the jet following the object. "The jet pulled up relatively fast from the south and everytime it would get close to the object, it (the UFO) would just pull away . . . like it was nothing."

Hunting Old And New UFOs In New Mexico

Now the UFO (or missile, if you wish) made an instantaneous right angle turn over the pass at Luna Mountain. "It made a due west turn, a 90 degree turn, and the jet could not maneuver that quick . . . it made a big loop and came in back of the object. (What an opportunity to say "it went to head it off at the pass!") "It took just a split second to make the turn . . . in just the blinking of an eye it had made the turn. We don't have any craft that can do that!"

The UFO then proceeded over the town of Luna where the Swapp brothers observed it. It was now going in a straight line and gaining altitude. "No sound, but perhaps some from the jet" Lance Swapp told us. No shape as discerned, but they saw two lights in between the two end lights which both Luscomb and Mrs. Hobbs had reported. "The lights were definitely attached to something . . . they moved exactly together".

As to apparent size, Lance said that his thumbnail, extended away from his eyes, would not have covered the lights. At two miles distance this translates to about 500 feet in length. This compares roughly with the Hobbs estimate of 250 yards and the Luscomb estimate of "four 747's in line".

The Swapp brothers apparently were the least excited about the sighting. "I really don't know what it was . . . might have been something the Air Force has". The jet never did catch up with the object, and the UFO was last seen blending in with the stars on high.

This is not the end of the story. The FAA in Albuquerque, at that moment in the person of Tony Herrera, was sympathetic but not helpful. Checking around to various radar installations, none had the object under surveillance, or so they said. Herrera's comment: "Well, you can call it your first encounter. I've always wanted to see something like that."

Now, however, comes a most puzzling part of the story. Some two hours later, Luscomb's nephew came in to get Dan. Four military jets were "sort of swooping in and out of the mountains . . . sort of a search pattern." Again Dan called Albuquerque. Nothing again! But Dan had a remote "rover" phone; taking it outside with him while he had Herrera on the phone, he had Herrera listen to the jets at the very moment Herrera was saying that nobody had any jets up.

"Well, do you hear this, Tony?"

"Yep, those are jets all right".

Herrera quickly checked again with White Sands, Phoenix, El Paso and Albuquerque, all places where fighter jets are stationed. Negative.

"No, Dan, they say they don't have anything up".

I asked Dan on the phone, "What did he say to the fact that he could actually hear the jets over the phone?" Dan answered that Herrera had replied, "Well, you know how the government is"



CUFOS

James Scartacinni (left) shows Lee Williams the site of the 1964 landing at Golden, New Mexico.

What can we gather from all this? Three sets of completely independent witnesses, separated by several miles from each other, were in essential agreement as to what had been observed. All agreed on the great size, the chasing jet, the direction of motion, the lack of sound, and two sets of witnesses had observed the 90 degree turn and the jet's inability to follow suit.

Mrs. Hobbs had seen the light rise abruptly from the ground. She estimated its rise point not greatly distant from her, but she could well have been mistaken. Although the directions do not agree, there are three obvious places from which an exotic missile could have been launched: White Sands, Holloman AFB at Alamogordo, and Cannon AFB at Clovis. A missile launched from those relatively distant points could have reached Reserve in 4 minutes if it were traveling at about 3000 miles per hour, but that certainly was not the observed speed of the object near Reserve. Further, a jet would hardly have covered the distance from any of those bases in that time and it, too, was observed to be traveling at normal jet speed. And it was not able to catch the object, the latter pulling away every time the jet came close.

Apparently something rose, noiselessly (all agreed on this) from a relatively short distance away and, a few minutes later, passed by the several independent observers at a distance of at most a few miles.

What will you have: a missile or a UFO? The Lady or the Tiger? IUR

FOOTNOTE: *There is a reference in the NICAP files to a case on this same date as the La Madera but filed under Edgewood, N.M. Edgewood is the closest "major" town to Golden.

FOOTNOTE: **The Socorro sighting occurred on April 24, 1964.

PROFILE

From time to time the Reporter will do a 'Profile' on someone who has made a positive contribution to Ufology, particularly on people who have tended to work quietly behind the scenes and hence are perhaps not as well known as they should be. One of the purposes will be to call attention to the less known facts about these leaders in Ufology. Robert (Bob) Gribble is one of these, and since it so happened that I had the opportunity of spending some time with him during a recent visit to Seattle and acquainting myself with his history, it is appropriate that he be the subject of our profile this time.

Bob Gribble is a retired fireman and was active in the Seattle Fire Department for thirty years, which is perhaps why he is conditioned to leaping out of bed at all hours of the night to answer calls to the UFO Reporting Center (206-722-3000), a number that has been in operation since 1974. Long before then, however, Bob was active in UFO data gathering. Oddly enough, he hadn't taken much interest in UFOs during the waves of 1947 and 1952 but in 1954 "just out of the clear sky", he told me, he suddenly developed a very strong interest in this field. It stemmed, he said, from a sort of "patriotic feeling" and a revulsion toward what he felt was censorship, and even possible conspiracy, on the part of the government in keeping UFO information from the public. He felt that he "had to get the word out to the people."

In short order he gathered around him an enthusiastic group originally called the "Space Observer's League" but later the "Aerial Phenomena Research Group". From 1970 on the organization was listed simply as "Phenomena Research." There were weekly meetings, and sometimes semi-weekly, which taxed the modest Gribble residence. When I asked Gloria Gribble how they fitted as many as forty or fifty people in she replied, "Very carefully". At its height the total group membership around the country numbered about 800.

Data collecting was the group's main activity, bringing together



ROBERT GRIBBLE

CUFOS

case reports from clipping services and the media in general. Among other things this resulted in a series of large maps of the United States, one for each year, showing all the UFO report locations by means of vari-colored pins (see photos Page 16). These maps dramatically display the unequal distribution of UFO reports from year to year. If one contrasts the 1965, 1967, and the 1973 maps, for example, one sees the fallacy of the statement that UFO flaps are produced by media 'hype.' If this were true, why then did not the Dakotas, Nebraska, Missouri, New Mexico and the central-western states in general have an abundance of UFO reports during that same time that the media were giving great prominence to the wave in the southeastern part of the country?

The Gribble group produced a publication, the APRG Reporter, which was published from 1956 to 1969 and is something of a collector's item now. Like many other publications, it faltered and suffered from the effects of inflation and variable support. Organizations of all kinds have their ups and down and this one was no exception. A particular ill to which UFO organizations in particular are subject to is the all-too-human desire to have quick answers, that is, to impatience. "They wanted to come up with answers right away . . . they couldn't stand the waiting period", Bob re-

lated. As a consequence, the group dwindled as the years went on to a mere handful. Inflation contributed also; "even the tacks we used on the maps went up to two or three dollars a box," Bob remarked.

Not even the flap of 1973 helped. At that time there were just too many reports and the group felt swamped and despaired of doing anything really constructive. The 1973 wave, however, spurred Bob; "While their interest went down, mine went up." But new blood came into the group and a new urge to collect and codify UFO reports grew. "What we need is our own telephone," someone said, and before long they had one. Beginning in 1974 the National UFO Reporting Center was born. Phone expenses were shared. The Center's phone number was sent to various FAA offices but this caused trouble; Bob had not gone "through channels." Finally, after some three years of negotiations, their number was included in the FAA Manual.

Today it is the reporting aspect of the work which remains as the focus of activity. "I've reached the point now where I can no longer split my efforts between calls and publications and membership activities. I'm putting all my time now in operating the Reporting Center and getting this information out to organizations who have the manpower to follow it up." Bob thus provides a valuable service to all major organizations, relaying significant reports to APRO, CUFOS and MUFON. He has sometimes been accused of just "sitting on the reports" he gets over his hot line. This is rather unjust since he openly admits that he does not have an investigative network and other resources to process reports 'in the field', and that someone else will just have to do the necessary investigations and the eventual publication of the results.

I asked Bob, "In looking back, can you estimate how much of your whole effort, from 1954 on, has cost you? Obviously a great deal in personal time and effort, but how much has this amounted to financially, especially seeing that for periods you had no formal membership dues?"

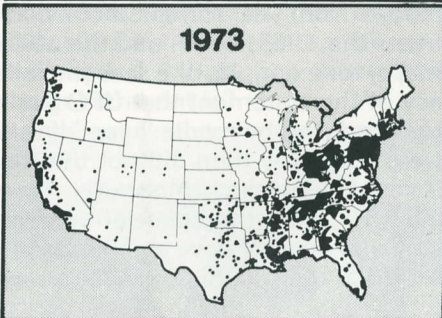
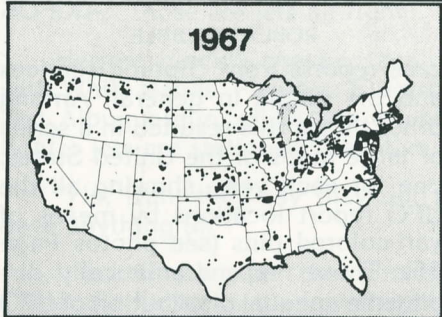
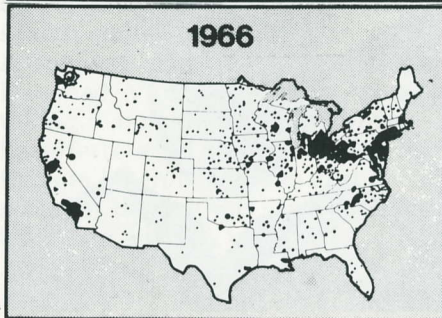
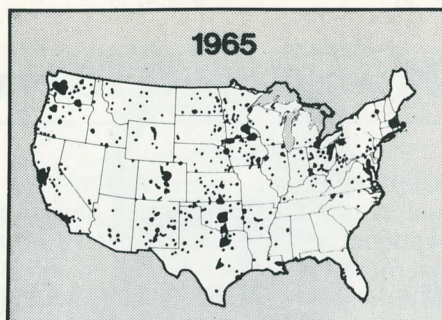
PROFILE

"I kept books for awhile," he said, "but I would say that as an absolute minimum, at least \$40,000."

Considering the number of years involved, this is not a surprising sum. Publication, postage, maintenance, etc. is expensive and everyone knows that there is no money in Ufology! There is no organization devoted to this work that I know of that has operated at a profit. The Center for UFO Studies certainly has not; its research efforts are always hampered by a lack of funds.

"What of the future?", I asked Bob. "What would be your advice to people just now getting started, and especially to the young people who are becoming seriously interested in Ufology?"

"I have a new slogan", Bob replied. "'Support UFO Research'" and I hope to have some bumper stickers made. I urge all who ask me about UFOs seriously to get associated . . . involved . . . with any of the three major organizations, or with all of them if they can afford it. But above all, I say, 'Keep an open mind'; We're in the 20th Century but our science is still in diapers. There might be civilizations that are millions of years in advance of ours, and mind control of matter could be an everyday thing with them."



Finally, we talked of the possibility of the next UFO report wave, or 'flap', and how we might best be prepared for it when and if it happens. He agreed that it is almost certain to happen and that there should be a master plan for cooperation when UFOs are prominently in the news again, especially should we have a repetition of the 1973 situation. "No one reporting center or no one organization is going to handle a major flap alone. If we get anything close to the '73 flap we're going to be going around the clock."

In the coming months, he felt, representatives of all UFO organizations . . . large and small . . . should meet to formulate contingency plans so that valuable scientific material should not 'go down the drain', as it surely would if we are caught unprepared and just stand by helplessly as the media carry story after story. Indeed, the situation should be reversed: responsible UFO organizations should help the media at such a time by holding coordinated press conferences and by issuing coordinated press releases to help hold down confusion and to separate the worthwhile from the garbage and, above all, to restrict irresponsible media reporting.

In the meantime, we salute Bob Gribble for having performed, and for continuing to perform, a valuable service for research in Ufology. For, all science must start with the collecting and evaluation of data.

IKJR

STOP!!! CHECK YOUR MAILING LABEL DATE

If the date shown on your label is 03/82 this is the anniversary of your last contribution to CUFOS and this is the last issue of IKJR you will receive until your next contribution is received by CUFOS. Thank you very much for your continued support. Action now will continue your mailings uninterrupted.

INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER, MARCH 1982
ISSN. # 0730-174X

Center For UFO Studies

Associates Education & Business Office
P.O. Box 1621
Lima, Ohio 45802

Nonprofit Organization
U.S. Postage
PAID
Permit No. 187
Lima, Ohio

Address Correction Requested